Transforming Marketing Education with Curriculum-Wide AI Integration

One discipline, every level: AI built into the marketing curriculum, from research methods to the capstone to an AI-in-Marketing course, with local businesses as clients.

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POSTER 13

Try it live

Beat the AI ▸ demo table

ODI chatbot · CALIPER · focus group

1 One discipline, every level

AI FAST built four plug-and-play modules (Foundations, Ethics, Strategy, Analytics) plus a capstone project, and faculty embedded them in courses they already teach.

AI in Business Hackathon
Real sponsor challenges

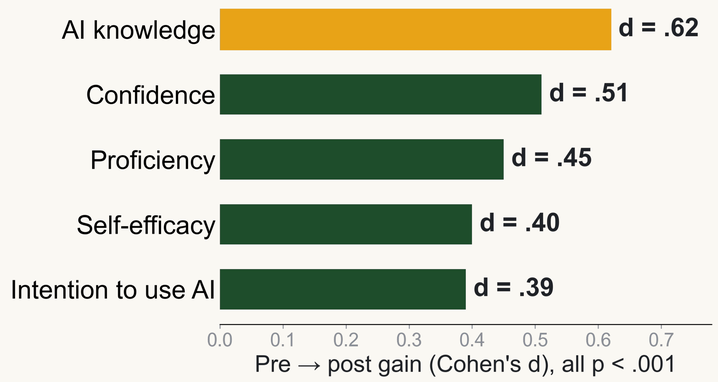
IBM 6450 AI in Marketing
Students build & validate AI tools

IBM 4212 Capstone
AI as a case study partner

IBM 3302 Marketing Research
AI respondents vs. real data

1,583	413	20	40
students surveyed	matched pre/post	faculty adopters	course sections

Students gained on every AI self-assessment



Equity: first-generation students gained the most self-efficacy (+0.65 vs. +0.35 for peers). Gains were equal across racial and ethnic groups (39.7% of matched students are Hispanic/Latino).

Honest note: the objective AI-literacy quiz did not move (d = 0.04). Next we assess skills, not only self-reports.

2 Featured modules

A · ODI Grips support chatbot IBM 6450 · IBM 4212

Harvard Business School case 626021 (2025): Bojinov, Cook, Lin, Chen, Kang & Stein. Client: ODI Grips, Riverside, CA (2025 MSDM capstone).

A business bot = four prompt blocks

- **Task** an ODI grip expert
- **Customer persona** racer or recreational rider
- **Tone** like a friendly service rep
- **Data access** the product catalog

Ablation: delete one block, clear the chat, re-run the tests.

Design tests the bot can fail

"I want the Rogue in green." With the catalog it says no: only black, blue, grey and red. Without it, the bot may invent a green one.

"Latest technology?" With the catalog: the Vanquish. Without it: older grips only.

1 · Watch (3 min) 2 · Then try it

▸ Can you make the bot invent a product? Try it at the table

B · CALIPER: build an AI text classifier IBM 6450

Students write a definition and label ~30 examples. Two AI coders and a judge turn their disagreements into written rules; the codebook is adopted only if it beats the plain definition.



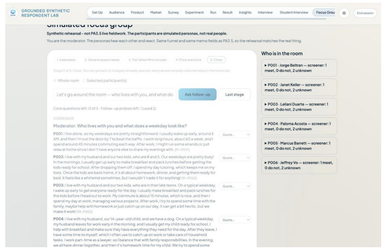
.573 → .809

mean F1 after refinement, on 395 airline chat turns (out-of-fold check built in)

1 · Watch (3 min) 2 · Then try it

C · Simulated focus group IBM 3302

Co-designed with Dr. Fan Wang and student developers Anderson Edmond, Minh Nhat Doan and Yaza M. Tun



Students rehearse moderating with 30 personas, then run a real focus group.

"Simulated data writes the first draft; real people get the final word."

Checked against a real n = 600 panel, AI respondents were too uniform: they missed the enthusiasts (8% top-2 box vs. 23% of people) and never said "not for me" (16% of people did).

1 · Watch (3 min) 2 · Then try it

3 Local businesses as clients

Students apply AI to real business problems with community partners, then compare AI output with real data.

Course module → **Client brief** → **AI vs. real data** → **Recommend**

Course client
Neo Smart Living (instagram.com/myneosmartliving), maker of the Tahoe Mini backyard unit, and aytm (aytm.com), which donated a national panel of n = 600

Hackathon sponsors
Avanade · ISACA Orange County · Insights Association West · Neo Smart Living & aytm

Capstone clients
ODI Grips (Riverside) · Dough Zone

4 client projects became published cases
ODI Grips (3) and Chunlei (1), on Harvard Business Publishing, so these clients' problems are now available to instructors everywhere. 3 CPP students are co-authors.

The 4 cases

2026 AI in Business Hackathon

320	50	64
students	teams	judges & mentors

AI-literacy self-rating rose pre → post (d = 0.33, p = .006, n = 73 matched).

At the demo table (2 minutes each)

1 **Beat the AI:** place three coffee brands, then flip to see where AI-simulated consumers and real students put them (IBM 6450 perceptual-map lesson).
2 **ODI chatbot:** watch the bot pass, then fail, a hallucination test.
3 **CALIPER:** watch an AI classifier get built, checked and frozen.
4 **Focus group:** moderate a room of AI personas.

Take it with you

All modules, rubrics, prompts and apps are ready to adapt.
Apps, videos, modules and recordings. The 1-minute form (right) gives the password.

CC BY-NC-SA 4.0: share and adapt with credit.

All the interactive apps are here

Adoption kit Get the password

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